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The theme of our conclave last year was the 'India Moment'. Well, I can confidently say the India Moment has only got bigger. Much bigger. Let's be ambitious and call it the 'India Movement'. This way, we remind ourselves of the work that needs to be done. So that we keep asking ourselves the big question—"What's next"? What can we do today to ensure that the India Moment lasts as long as possible? And convert it into a movement? So that it transforms India like no other in the past. To me, the best way to build a better future is to have a clear vision of that future. And then work towards turning that vision into reality. Today, I want to submit to you five images of India's future that I think are within our grasp.

Firstly, forget about the Poverty Line, which is so often discussed in India, and let's convert it into what I would call the Dignity Line.

Less than a month ago, the government released data that suggested extreme poverty in India is almost eliminated. It is now indeed restricted to less than two per cent of India's population. But I must tell you that extreme poverty is a very low bar to clear. According to the World Bank, poverty is defined as the consumption expenditure of $2.15 PPP dollars a day. That's Purchasing Power Parity, which means the dollar is about half the value of the US dollar. This means roughly Rs 1,200-Rs 1,500 a month or just Rs 40-80 a day. In the last 10 years, the present government has done a remarkable job of lifting more than 200 million people above the extreme poverty line.

Now, let's set the bar to the dignity line. It's a line that measures the means to lead a life of basic dignity. That includes food, of course, but it also includes access to basic housing, electricity, clean water, education and healthcare. And, of course, a job that gives a basic income. I think Prime Minister Narendra Modi has grasped this idea of delivering a life of dignity for the people at the bottom of the pyramid from the time he took office 10 years ago. That is why his emphasis on schemes like Swachh Bharat and delivering tap water and electricity to every household.

Also, NITI Aayog does not measure poverty by poverty line any more but by what they call multi-dimensional poverty. This is a most welcome step. The current estimate suggests 11.3 per cent of Indians are below the multi-dimensional poverty line. Five years from now, we should target to have either zero or no more than two per cent of Indians below this line. That's when nearly every Indian will have a fair opportunity to make the most of what life offers us.

Forget the Poverty Line, let's convert it into the Dignity Line, which measures the means to lead a life with dignity. It includes food, but also access to basic housing, electricity, clean water, education, healthcare and a job that gives basic income

Second is Education. No country has become a developed one without a good education system. In education, we have solved the enrolment problem. But what happens—or doesn't happen—between enrolment and graduation remains unaddressed. This shows up in the large teaching and learning gaps on the one hand and a historically high youth unemployment on the other.

A recent survey showed that 25 per cent of 14-18-year-olds could not read a simple Class 2 level text in their regional language. Less than 50 per cent of them could solve Grade 2-level maths. This is a very sad state of affairs that does not bode well for the future of this country. Quality